

# Proof by rebuild

Our entire cloud environment is defined in one repository, deployed by pipeline, checked by an independent auditor, and destroyed and rebuilt on demand. We do not assert that our controls work. We rebuild the environment and demonstrate it.

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| <b>Audit evidence is produced continuously</b><br>Every deployment records what was checked, what was expected, and what was found. Preparing for an audit becomes retrieval rather than a project. | <b>Recovery is exercised, not documented</b><br>The environment is destroyed and rebuilt as routine practice rather than an annual tabletop. Recovery time is measured, not estimated.  |
| <b>Cloud spend is attributable by construction</b><br>Resources cannot be created without the tags that assign an owner and a cost centre. There is no unattributed spend to reconcile later.       | <b>Security fixes ship without added headcount</b><br>Vulnerabilities are found, patched, tested and deployed unattended. Leadership reviews the record instead of approving each step. |

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|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>90 min</b><br>DESTROY AND REBUILD, MEASURED | <b>\$15</b><br>MONTHLY RUN COST, 99% ONE DATABASE | <b>57</b><br>INDEPENDENTLY VERIFIED CRITERIA | <b>2,719</b><br>AUTOMATED TESTS |
| <b>0</b><br>STORED AZURE CREDENTIALS           |                                                   |                                              |                                 |

WHAT IT REMOVES FROM THE RISK REGISTER

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|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>No credential to steal</b>              | Pipelines and services authenticate with short-lived federated identity. No cloud key is stored anywhere, and the database has no password in existence to leak or rotate.         |
| <b>Drift cannot accumulate</b>             | Nothing is changed by hand. Anything that diverges from the repository fails verification and surfaces immediately, rather than being discovered during an incident.               |
| <b>Separation of duties is structural</b>  | The identity that deploys cannot verify, and the identity that verifies cannot write. The boundary is enforced by the system, not by policy alone.                                 |
| <b>Classified work has a governed home</b> | Sensitivity labelling, including export-controlled handling, is provisioned as code and persists across rebuilds — a property of the environment rather than a habit of its users. |

A working environment, not an architecture diagram — demonstrable end to end from an empty subscription, inside a single meeting.